

mishap and detention merely gave Francis Story another opportunity to discuss Buddhism. Even his rare complaints about the conditions of our work always had humour in them. Once when we were rushing hectically to catch a train at a crowded railway station in a South Asian country he remarked: "This is an impossible country. You cannot even count on the trains departing late!" On another trip, when we had almost exhausted our informants and ourselves and had partaken of nothing since breakfast but chopped open coconuts, he allowed himself to say, toward 5:00 PM, "I have quite stopped thinking about lunch. My only concern now as regards food is whether I shall have any supper!"

In view of his willingness to undergo deprivations of this kind, it is not surprising that the first symptoms of his fatal illness came on when he had to stand for hours during a long train journey taken to investigate a case in eastern Sri Lanka. He spent much of this time with his chest against a rather sharp ledge. Afterwards he had persistent pain in the area of his chest where the ledge had pressed him. Examination showed that he had developed at that place a pathological fracture of a rib. That was early in 1970. By the autumn he was severely weakened, in much pain, and using a cane. But he accompanied me just as usual throughout most of my investigations in Sri Lanka during November of that year.

His cheerful tolerance of the austerities of field investigations represented the least important contribution he made to the study of the cases. He and I both regarded these as merely incidental features in the gathering of the data. Far more important was his participation as an analyst of the evidence and an assessor of its value. Almost always on our field trips we worked until late at night in going over the notes of the day's interviews. Francis Story's agile mind constantly thought of new questions for the next day's work or new ways of understanding the testimony we had already obtained.

The discussion of cases with him gave me not only pleasure, but an assistance whose true worth I did not appreciate until much later. As I think now about my ignorance of South Asian peoples in the early 1960s I realize that if I had allowed myself to become aware of it then I would never have made my first journey for investigations. I should have lost my nerve before departure. I only realized much later the good fortune I had in that, from the very beginning of my field work, Francis Story made his rich experience of South Asian peoples available to me. Many times his extraordinarily wide knowledge of the cultures of the area clarified some discrepancy or obscure item in the informants' statements or the behaviour of the subject. One of his other friends told me quite credibly that in at least some